

UVALO ALUSEKHO



“FEAR IS NO LONGER” — A MESSAGE CARRIED IN THE BONE

This is not a declaration from someone who has healed.
It is a letter written from the middle of the wound.
And still — it is a message I was called to carry.

I write to Black people — to those born of displaced bloodlines, fractured lands, and spiritual systems that were interrupted but never destroyed.

This letter is an offering from the spaces I've had to sit in: paralysis, silence, slow pain, isolation. Not poetic struggle — but raw, unedited reality.

“Uvalo Alusekho” — Fear Is No Longer — is not an arrival. It's the work. It's a code I was given during my own interruption: when the world as I knew it fell apart, and I was forced to confront what my spirit was built on — and what needed to be unlearned.

Across the continent, before the rise of colonial and imperial disruption, African spiritual systems were not structured on fear.

In fact, fear as a dominant organizing principle is largely a colonial inheritance.

Precolonial African cosmologies — from the cosmogram of the Kongo people, to the Zulu understanding of uMvelinqangi, to the Dogon's intricate celestial systems — were constructed around harmony, relationality, accountability, and cyclical time.

To fear the divine was not to dread it, but to respect the balance it maintained.

There was no heaven to earn or hell to burn in — there was only alignment or misalignment with natural law, ancestral order, and spiritual rhythm.

The interruption came when spirituality was severed from land and replaced with control.

Colonial and missionary projects across the continent reframed spirit as something to be feared and obeyed — not something to be embodied or remembered.

Fear became not just a reaction, but a system of control: infused in religion, education, economy, and identity.

Generational trauma, political violence, and systemic poverty have normalized this fear as a foundation for daily life.

For Black people, this manifests as inherited hyper-vigilance, suppressed grief, and an internalized disbelief in rest, softness, or abundance.

We mistake fear for wisdom. We confuse anxiety for spiritual caution. We dress trauma as tradition.

When I say “Fear Is No Longer,” I am not denying the presence of danger or injustice.

I am saying that fear must no longer be the foundation we build on.

“Uvalo Alusekho” is the beginning of a different relationship to spirit.

It is the refusal to allow inherited panic to shape our rituals, choices, or identities.

It is a call to remember that Black people once spoke to the stars not to escape, but to understand. That temples were built in alignment with the earth's magnetic fields — not to secure favor, but to maintain balance.

That ancestral guidance was everyday technology — not mysticism.

My own pain became a classroom. Not because I wanted it to be — but because there was no other way to survive.

I was forced to sit with the broken parts of myself, the terrified parts, the ones no prayer could touch — and still find meaning.

It was there that I understood:

the fear I was raised to carry was never mine. It was designed.

And it is no longer required.

This book is not a performance of healing.

It is a practice in truth-telling.

And this first truth is that fear has no place in how we relate to our ancestors, our bodies, our minds, or each other.

I am still afraid.





THE PSYCHOLOGICAL HIJACKING OF BLACK BELIEF SYSTEMS

The spiritual systems practiced by Black people prior to colonization were based on relationship, not obedience. They centered land, lineage, energy, rhythm, and reciprocity. From the Igbo concept of Chi, to the Akan's Sunsum and Kra, to the Zulu's veneration of amaDlozi, spirituality was deeply personal, land-based, and emotionally intuitive.

But across the 18th and 19th centuries, colonial powers — particularly through missionary education, Western psychology, and Christian doctrine — dismantled these systems by attaching fear, shame, and punishment to practices that had once been about collective balance.

In psychology, this process is known as spiritual bypassing and internalized oppression. Generations of Black people were taught to fear their own rituals — to doubt their dreams, suppress their intuition, and view ancestral memory as demonic. What had once been sources of guidance became sources of confusion and terror.

As a result, many Black people today experience anxiety, guilt, and emotional suppression around their own spirituality.

This fear is not natural. It was installed.

We cannot heal what we're still afraid to name.

The first step in reclaiming Black spiritual knowledge is admitting that the fear attached to it is not indigenous — it is inherited, constructed, and reversible.







HOW WESTERN SYSTEMS DISLOCATED SPIRIT FROM SELF

The colonial education system was never neutral — it was a tool of ideological warfare. In many African countries, including South Africa, education under colonial and apartheid regimes was designed to disconnect Black children from their own cultural logic, languages, and spiritual epistemologies.

Subjects like philosophy, science, and even art were taught exclusively from Eurocentric frameworks. Indigenous African cosmologies were either erased or repackaged as superstition. This wasn't just about content — it was about epistemicide: the killing of ways of knowing.

Frantz Fanon wrote about this in *Black Skin, White Masks* — that colonized people internalize the idea that to be “rational,” “educated,” or “civilized” is to reject their own spiritual and emotional intelligence.

The result? A fractured sense of self. A Black soul trained to mistrust its own memory.

Even today, many Black creatives, healers, and leaders struggle to fully trust their inner voice — because the systems they were raised in trained them to believe that what is valid must be measurable, Western, and emotionally detached.

But African knowledge systems never separated intellect from spirit.

The healer was also a scientist. The dancer was also a historian. The grandmother was also a philosopher.

We have been made to forget that our minds are still sacred.

Reclaiming Black spirituality means restoring trust in our own intelligence.

Not just intellectual intelligence — but emotional, spiritual, and ancestral knowledge that Western education taught us to fear or dismiss.

There is no decolonization without epistemic return.







HOW FEAR WAS SYSTEMATICALLY INSTALLED INTO BLACK CONSCIOUSNESS

The fear that many Black people carry toward ancestral practices, intuitive wisdom, and emotional truth is not accidental — it is the result of long-term psychological engineering. This engineering occurred through colonial education, Christian missionary work, legal systems, and media narratives, all working together to sever spirit from self.

1. Demonization of African Spirituality through Missionary Work

- In the 1800s and early 1900s, Christian missionaries across Africa labeled indigenous spiritual practices as “witchcraft” and “savagery.”
 - In South Africa, laws like the Witchcraft Suppression Act (1957) criminalized traditional healers and indigenous practices.
 - Rituals that connected people to land, ancestors, or spirit were reframed as dangerous or demonic.
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- The result? Entire generations learned to associate ancestral rituals, dreams, drumming, or divination with Satanism — even within families.

2. Education Systems That Erased African Worldviews

- Colonial and apartheid education systems taught from a strictly Western framework.
- In South Africa, the Bantu Education Act (1953) was designed to train Black children for servitude, not intellectual or spiritual development.
 - African cosmologies (like Ubuntu, Maat, or the Zulu cosmology of uMvelinqangi) were excluded from curricula — replaced with European philosophies and histories.
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- Children were punished for speaking their languages or questioning the logic of Christianity or capitalism.
 - This created a deep link between fear and self-expression — especially when it came to spirituality.
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3. Public Shaming and Punishment

- In missionary schools and churches, traditional practices were often exposed and shamed publicly:
 - Children were made to renounce ancestral customs in front of congregations.
 - Objects like beads, herbs, or traditional attire were confiscated or burned.
 - “Christian names” replaced indigenous names — a direct rupture between person and heritage.
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This public shaming created intergenerational trauma and cultural self-hate, where children grew up afraid of their own elders’ practices.

4. Psychological Labeling and Pathologization

- With the rise of Western psychiatry and psychology, indigenous spiritual experiences — such as visions, ancestral visitations, or trance states — were often pathologized.
 - Dreams were labeled hallucinations.
 - Mediumship was diagnosed as schizophrenia or delusion.
 - Ancestral callings (ukuthwasa) were treated as mental illness, rather than a rite of passage.
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This severed many Black people from their own spiritual callings, especially in urban spaces, where they feared being labeled “mad.”

5. Reinforcement Through Media and Pop Culture

- Global media — often shaped by Hollywood and Christian evangelical narratives — portrayed African spiritual systems as evil:
 - Sangomas and traditional healers were shown as dangerous, backward, or demonic.
 - In horror films, African symbols and rituals are commonly used to signify darkness and fear.
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These images circulate globally and subconsciously influence how Black people view their own traditions — even today.

The cumulative result of these systems is that many Black people today — even when curious or called — experience fear when returning to ancestral knowledge.

This fear is not innate. It is a product of systemic psychological, religious, and cultural warfare.

To decolonize spirituality, we must first name the systems that taught us to fear ourselves.
Only then can we begin to recover the Black soul's original shape — wise, intuitive, unafraid.

